

Word family: **kind / kinds / kindly / kindness / unkind / unkindly / kind-hearted**

Base word: kind

Plural noun: kinds

Related forms: kindly, kindness, unkind, unkindly, kind-hearted

Useful constructions/extensions: a kind of, this/that kind of, what kind of, all kinds of, kind of + adjective/verb, one of a kind, of a kind, kind to someone, kind of someone to do something, kindness, kindly, unkind, kind-hearted

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective (形容詞) / related adverb and noun forms (相關副詞及名詞)

Your passage contains:

> “Even so, I knew this was **the kind of opportunity** I could not keep avoiding.”

Here, **kind** is a **noun**.

It means:

type, sort, or category of thing.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **the kind of opportunity**

kind means:

a particular type or category of opportunity.

You are saying that this opportunity belonged to a category of experiences that:

* frightened you;

* challenged you;

* could help you grow;

* should not be avoided forever.

Meaning: A type, sort, or category of person, thing, situation, or experience.

繁體中文: 某一類型／某一種……; 按照共同特徵歸類的一類事物

中文翻譯:

> “I knew this was the kind of opportunity I could not keep avoiding.”

「我知道這是**那種我不能一直逃避的機會**。」

So:

****the kind of opportunity = 這一類／這種機會****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****kind = type/sort/category (種類) — 種; 類型; 類別****

This is the exact core meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** A group or category of people or things that share similar characteristics.

Practice 1 — Original

> “This was ****the kind of opportunity**** I could not keep avoiding.”

「這是****那種我不能一直逃避的機會****。」

Practice 2

> “What ****kind of presentation**** are you giving?”

「你要做的是****哪一類型的簡報****？」

Practice 3

> “This ****kind of experience**** can build confidence.”

「這****類經歷****可以建立自信。」

****kind = 按照共同特徵、用途或性質歸在一起的一種類別****

2. ****a kind of + noun (某一種……) — 一種; 某類****

A very common pattern.

Practice 4

> “It was **a kind of test** for me.”

「對我來說，那是**一種考驗**。」

Practice 5

> “This is **a kind of training**.”

「這是**一種訓練**。」

a kind of + noun = 某一類別／某一形式的事物

3. **this/that kind of + noun** (這／那一類.....) — 這種; 那種

Practice 6

> “I had never faced **that kind of pressure** before.”

「我以前從未面對過**那種壓力**。」

Practice 7

> “I enjoy **this kind of work**.”

「我喜歡**這類工作**。」

this/that kind of + noun = 指某一已知或特定類型的事物

4. **what kind of + noun?** (甚麼種類) — 哪一種; 甚麼類型

Practice 8

> “What **kind of audience** were you speaking to?”

「你面對的是**哪一類觀眾**？」

Practice 9

> “What **kind of job** are you looking for?”

「你正在找**哪一類工作**？」

what kind of = 詢問某人／某物屬於甚麼類型或具有甚麼性質

5. **all kinds of + plural/uncountable noun**(各種各樣) — 各種;各式各樣

Practice 10

> “I imagined **all kinds of problems** before the presentation.”

「簡報前, 我想像了**各種各樣的問題**。」

Practice 11

> “The event attracted **all kinds of people**.”

「活動吸引了**各式各樣的人**。」

all kinds of = 很多不同種類／形式的

Often means:

> a wide variety of

6. **different kinds of**(不同種類) — 不同類型的

Practice 12

> “There are many **different kinds of presentations**.”

「簡報有很多**不同類型**。」

Practice 13

> “People react to pressure in **different kinds of ways**.”

「人面對壓力時會有**不同類型的反應方式**。」

****different kinds of = 屬於多個不同類別／形式的****

7. ****one kind of ... another kind of ... (一類.....另一類.....) — 一種; 另一種****

Practice 14

> “Public speaking is one ****kind of challenge****; leadership is another.”

「公開演講是****一種挑戰****, 領導工作是另一種。」

Practice 15

> “This is one ****kind of solution****, but there are others.”

「這只是****其中一種解決方法****, 還有其他方法。」

****one kind / another kind = 用來區分同一大類之下不同的種類****

8. ****kind = sort/type of person (某種人) — 類型; 那種人****

Practice 16

> “She is the ****kind of person**** who prepares carefully.”

「她是****那種會仔細準備的人****。」

Practice 17

> “He’s not the ****kind of manager**** who gives up easily.”

「他不是****那種會輕易放棄的經理****。」

****the kind of person who... = 具有某種典型性格／行為特徵的人****

9. ****kind of + adjective/verb (有點; 某程度上) — 有點; 算是; 某程度上****

This is a very important informal grammatical extension.

Here **kind of** no longer literally means “type of.”

Practice 18

> “I was **kind of nervous** before the presentation.”

「簡報前我**有點緊張**。」

Practice 19

> “I **kind of understood** what he meant.”

「我**大概／某程度上明白**他的意思。」

kind of + adjective/verb = 程度不完全、較模糊或較委婉；有點／某程度上

This is especially common in spoken English.

10. **kind of = approximately / vaguely (大概；有點像) — 某程度上；大概**

Practice 20

> “It was **kind of a turning point** for me.”

「對我來說，那**某程度上算是一個轉捩點**。」

Practice 21

> “The design is **kind of unusual**.”

「這個設計**有點不尋常**。」

kind of = 表示說法不是百分之百精確，而是大致、近似或較委婉

11. **one of a kind (獨一無二) — 獨一無二的；很特別的**

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 22

> “Her presentation style is **one of a kind**.”

「她的簡報風格是**獨一無二的**。」

Practice 23

> “This handmade piece is **one of a kind**.”

「這件手作品是**獨一無二的**。」

one of a kind = 沒有另一個完全相同的; 非常獨特

12. **of a kind** (某種程度上相似／勉強算同類) — 某種; 算是同一類

A more advanced expression.

Practice 24

> “They reached an agreement **of a kind**.”

「他們達成了一個**勉強算是協議的安排**。」

Practice 25

> “It was a success **of a kind**.”

「那**某程度上也算是成功**。」

of a kind = 勉強可歸入某類, 但未必完全符合一般標準

Often carries a qualifying or slightly skeptical tone.

13. **kind** = caring / considerate (友善體貼的) — 親切的; 善良的; 體貼的

Now **kind** is an **adjective**.

This is a completely different core meaning from **kind** = type.

Meaning: Caring about other people and behaving in a gentle, helpful, or considerate way.

Practice 26

> “She was very **kind** when I made a mistake.”

「我犯錯時，她對我非常**友善／體貼**。」

Practice 27

> “He is a **kind** and patient manager.”

「他是一位**善良而有耐性的經理**。」

kind = 願意關心、幫助和體諒別人，態度友善而不刻薄的

14. **kind to + person/animal** (對.....友善) — 對.....好; 善待

Practice 28

> “My colleagues were **kind to me** before the presentation.”

「簡報前，同事們都**對我很好／很友善**。」

Practice 29

> “Be **kind to** yourself when you make mistakes.”

「犯錯時也要**善待自己**。」

be kind to someone = 對某人表現關心、友善、體諒或幫助

15. **It is kind of someone to do something** (某人做某事很體貼) —真好／很體貼

Practice 30

> “It was **kind of her** to help me practise.”

「她幫我練習，**真的很體貼／很好**。」

Practice 31

> “It was **kind of you to say that**.”

「你這樣說，**真的很友善／很貼心**。」

It is/was kind of someone to do = 某人的行為顯示出善意、體貼或樂於幫助

Important grammar:

> **kind of someone**

here means:

> 這個人很體貼地做了……

This is totally different from informal:

> **kind of tired**

= 有點累

16. **kind words** (好話／暖心說話) — 親切鼓勵的說話

Practice 32

> “Her **kind words** helped me calm down.”

「她那些**親切鼓勵的說話**令我平靜下來。」

Practice 33

> “Thank you for your **kind words**.”

「謝謝你的**暖心／善意說話**。」

kind words = 充滿善意、支持、鼓勵或體諒的說話

17. **kind gesture/act** (善意行為) — 善舉；體貼行動

Practice 34

> “Helping me check the slides was a **kind gesture**.”

「幫我檢查投影片是一個**很體貼的善意舉動**。」

Practice 35

> “It was a simple but **kind act**.”

「那是一個簡單但很**有善意的行動**。」

kind gesture/act = 顯示關心、幫助或體諒別人的行為

18. **kind** = gentle / not harsh (溫和的; 不傷害的) — 溫和的; 不苛刻的

A broader extension.

Practice 36

> “The feedback was honest but **kind**.”

「那些回饋很坦白, 但態度很**溫和／體諒人**。」

Practice 37

> “Try to be **kind** when correcting someone.”

「糾正別人時要盡量**溫和體貼**。」

kind = 以不刻薄、不殘酷、不過分嚴厲的方式對待別人

19. **kindness** (善意／仁慈) — 善良; 友善; 體貼

A major related noun.

Practice 38

> “I appreciated my colleagues’ **kindness**.”

「我很感激同事的**友善和體貼**。」

Practice 39

> “A little **kindness** can make someone feel more confident.”

「一點**善意**可以令人更有信心。」

kindness = 關心、體諒、幫助和善待別人的品質／行為

20. **an act of kindness**(善舉) — 善意行動; 善舉

Practice 40

> “Helping a nervous colleague can be a small **act of kindness**.”

「幫助緊張的同事可以是一個小小的**善舉**。」

Practice 41

> “The stranger’s **act of kindness** surprised her.”

「陌生人的**善意行動**令她很驚訝。」

an act of kindness = 具體表現關心、幫助或善意的一個行動

21. **kindly** = in a kind way(友善地) — 親切地; 善意地

Practice 42

> “She **kindly** offered to check my script.”

「她很**好心**地／**親切**地主動幫我檢查講稿。」

Practice 43

> “He spoke **kindly** to the nervous employee.”

「他很**溫和親切**地跟那名緊張的員工說話。」

kindly = 以友善、關心或體貼的方式

22. **kindly = please (請; 較正式) — 請; 煩請**

A distinct adverb use, especially formal.

Practice 44

> “**Kindly** send the completed form by Friday.”

「**請／煩請**在星期五前交回填妥的表格。」

Practice 45

> “**Kindly** take your seats.”

「**請**各位就座。」

kindly + verb = 較正式地提出要求; 請／煩請

Depending on tone, it can sometimes sound firm rather than warm.

23. **unkind (不友善的) — 不友善的; 刻薄的**

The direct opposite.

Practice 46

> “It would be **unkind** to laugh at someone’s mistake.”

「取笑別人的錯誤會很**不友善／刻薄**。」

Practice 47

> “His comment was unnecessarily **unkind**.”

「他的評論沒有必要地**刻薄**。」

unkind = 缺乏友善、體諒或善意, 並可能令人受傷的

24. **unkind to someone (對某人不好) — 刻薄對待; 不友善**

Practice 48

> “Don’t be **unkind to** yourself after one mistake.”

「不要因一個錯誤就**對自己太苛刻**。」

Practice 49

> “She was never **unkind to** her colleagues.”

「她從不**刻薄對待同事**。」

be unkind to = 對某人缺乏體諒、友善或善意

25. **kind-hearted (心地善良的) — 心地善良的; 仁厚的**

A useful compound adjective.

Practice 50

> “She is a **kind-hearted** manager.”

「她是一位**心地善良的經理**。」

Practice 51

> “A **kind-hearted** colleague stayed to help me.”

「一位**心地善良的同事**留下來幫我。」

kind-hearted = 本性善良、富有同情心並願意幫助別人的

26. **kindness to + person/animal (善待) — 對……的善意／仁慈**

Practice 52

> “Her **kindness to** new employees was well known.”

「她對新員工的**友善和照顧**很出名。」

Practice 53

> “The organization promotes **kindness to animals**.”

「該機構提倡**善待動物**。」

kindness to someone = 對某人／動物表現出的關心、體諒和善意

27. **kindred (同類／有共同特質; 較遠的相關詞) — 同類的; 志趣相投的**

This is historically related but should not be treated as a direct ordinary derivative of modern **kind**.

A useful expression is:

> **kindred spirit**

= 志趣相投的人／知音

Practice 54

> “She felt that she had found a **kindred spirit**.”

「她覺得自己找到了一個**志趣相投的人／知音**。」

This belongs better in a family-extension note than as another sense of bare **kind**.

Important distinction: **kind = type vs kind = caring**

This is the biggest contrast.

Noun:

> “What **kind** of presentation is it?”

= 這是**哪一種類型**的簡報？

Adjective:

> “She was very **kind** to me.”

= 她對我非常**友善／體貼**。

Same spelling, completely different concept.

Important distinction: **kind of opportunity** vs **kind opportunity**

This is useful for your passage.

kind of opportunity

= type/category of opportunity

> “the **kind of opportunity** I could not avoid”

= 那**一類／那種**我不能逃避的機會

kind opportunity

would sound as though the opportunity itself were somehow benevolent or considerate, which is not the intended meaning.

So the grammar identifies the sense:

> **kind of + noun** → 種類

Important distinction: **kind of = type** vs **kind of = somewhat**

These look identical but function differently.

Type:

> “What **kind of job** is it?”

= 甚麼**種類**的工作？

Informal degree:

> “I’m **kind of tired**.”

= 我**有點累**。

In the second, **kind of** acts like a hedge/intensifier meaning:

> somewhat / a little.

Important distinction: **a kind of vs kind of**

a kind of + noun

normally means:

> a type of

> “Yoga is a kind of exercise.”

= 瑜伽是一種運動。

kind of + adjective/verb

often means informally:

> somewhat

> “I kind of understand.”

= 我大概明白。

The article **a** and what follows the expression help distinguish the use.

Important distinction: **kind vs type**

These overlap strongly in the category meaning.

kind

is very common in everyday English:

> “What kind of music do you like?”

type

can sound slightly more analytical/technical:

> “What type of device is this?”

Both often mean:

> 種類／類型

But collocation and register vary.

Important distinction: **kind vs sort**

For the category sense, **kind** and **sort** are very close.

> “What kind of work do you do?”

> “What sort of work do you do?”

Both natural.

Sort is especially common in British English.

Both can also become informal hedges:

> sort of tired

> kind of tired

= 有點累

Important distinction: **kind vs category**

kind

is natural everyday vocabulary.

category

is more formal/systematic and suggests explicit classification.

Compare:

> “What kind of film is it?”

everyday

> “The products are divided into three categories.”

systematic classification

So:

kind = 種類

category = 分類系統中的類別

Important distinction: kind vs nice

These overlap in social descriptions.

kind

focuses on:

- * caring;
- * considerate;
- * helpful;
- * compassionate behaviour.

nice

is broader and can mean:

- * pleasant;
- * friendly;
- * enjoyable;
- * good.

> “She is kind.”

strongly suggests she treats people well.

> “She is nice.”

is broader and less specific.

Important distinction: ****kind vs friendly****

****friendly****

focuses on:

> warm, pleasant social behaviour.

****kind****

focuses more on:

> caring about someone's well-being and acting considerately/helpfully.

Someone can be friendly without doing anything particularly kind.

Someone can also perform a kind act without being especially sociable.

Important distinction: ****kind vs polite****

****polite****

= follows social manners/respect.

****kind****

= shows genuine consideration or compassion.

A person can be:

> polite but unkind

if their manners are correct but their actions lack compassion.

So:

****polite = 有禮貌****

****kind = 善良／體貼****

Important distinction: **kind vs generous**

**kind**

is broad and concerns caring treatment.

**generous**

focuses more on willingly giving:

- * money;
- * time;
- * help;
- * resources.

Generosity can be one form of kindness, but they are not identical.

Important distinction: **kind vs gentle**

**kind**

= caring/considerate.

**gentle**

= soft, mild, not rough or harsh.

> “a kind teacher”

= 關心學生的老師

> “a gentle voice”

= 溫柔的聲音

They often overlap in behaviour, but not in core meaning.

Important distinction: **kindly = warmly vs kindly = please**

This is an important polyfunctionality point.

Warmly:

> “She kindly helped me.”

= 她**好心**幫了我。

Formal request:

> “Kindly submit the form.”

= **請／煩請**提交表格。

The second can sound formal and sometimes firm rather than emotionally kind.

Important distinction: **kind of you vs kind of tired**

This is a classic learner trap.

It was kind of you to help.

Here:

kind = caring

and:

of you identifies the person whose behaviour was kind.

= 你願意幫忙，真是很體貼。

I’m kind of tired.

Here:

****kind of = somewhat****

= 我有點累。

Same words, completely different grammar.

Important distinction: **one of a kind vs a kind of**

**one of a kind**

= unique

> “The design is one of a kind.”

= 設計獨一無二。

**a kind of**

= one type/category

> “This is a kind of design software.”

= 這是一種設計軟件。

Almost opposite ideas:

****one of a kind = 沒有同類****

****a kind of = 屬於某一類****

Important distinction: **kindness vs kind**

**kind**

adjective:

> “She is kind.”

kindness

noun:

> “I appreciated her kindness.”

So:

kind = 友善／善良的

kindness = 友善／善意這種品質或行為

Important distinction: **kind-hearted vs kind**

kind

can describe one action or general behaviour.

kind-hearted

more strongly describes someone's underlying character.

> “That was kind of him.”

= 那次行為很體貼。

> “He is kind-hearted.”

= 他本性心地善良。

Family-extension sweep

The practical **kind** family is rich because of the sharp noun/adjective split and several fixed constructions:

* **kind — type/category** = 種類／類型

* **a kind of + noun** = 一種.....

* **this/that kind of** = 這／那一類.....

* **what kind of** = 哪一類／甚麼種類

* **all kinds of** = 各式各樣

* **different kinds of** = 不同種類

* **kind of person** = 某類型的人
 * **kind of + adjective/verb** = 有點／某程度上(非正式)
 * **one of a kind** = 獨一無二
 * **of a kind** = 勉強算某一類／某種形式
 * **kind — caring** = 善良／友善／體貼的
 * **kind to someone** = 對某人友善
 * **kind of someone to do something** = 某人這樣做很體貼
 * **kind words** = 善意／鼓勵的說話
 * **kind gesture/act** = 善意舉動
 * **kindness** = 善良／善意／體貼
 * **act of kindness** = 善舉
 * **kindly — warmly** = 好心地／親切地
 * **kindly — please** = 請／煩請(較正式)
 * **unkind** = 不友善／刻薄的
 * **kind-hearted** = 心地善良的
 * **kindness to** = 對某人／動物的善意
 * **kindred spirit** = 志趣相投的人(較遠的相關詞)

The main semantic branches are:

> **type / category**

and

> **caring / considerate**

with **kind of = somewhat** developing as an important informal grammatical extension.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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kind — type/category	按共同特徵、用途或性質歸在一起的一種類別／類型
a kind of + noun	某一種類別／形式的事物；一種.....
this/that kind of	指某個已知或特定類型的事物；這種／那種
what kind of	詢問某人／某物屬於甚麼類型或具有甚麼性質
all kinds of	很多不同種類／形式的；各式各樣
different kinds of	屬於多個不同類別／形式的
kind of person	具有某種典型性格、身份或行為特徵的人
kind of + adjective/verb	非正式表示程度不完全或較模糊；有點／某程度上
one of a kind	沒有另一個完全相同的；獨一無二的
of a kind	勉強可歸入某類，但未必完全符合一般標準

kind — caring	願意關心、幫助和體諒別人，態度友善而不刻薄的	
kind to someone	對某人表現關心、友善、體諒或幫助	
kind of someone to do something	某人的行為顯示出善意、體貼或樂於幫助	
kind words	充滿善意、支持、鼓勵或體諒的說話	
kind gesture/act	顯示關心、幫助或體諒別人的具體行動	
kindness	關心、體諒、幫助和善待別人的品質／行為	
an act of kindness	具體表現關心、幫助或善意的一個行動	
kindly — in a kind way	以友善、關心或體貼的方式	
kindly — please	較正式地提出要求；請／煩請	
unkind	缺乏友善、體諒或善意，並可能令別人受傷的	
kind-hearted	本性善良、富同情心並願意幫助別人的	
kindness to someone	對某人／動物表現出的關心、體諒和善意	

For your original passage

> “Even so, I knew this was ****the kind of opportunity**** I could not keep avoiding.”

The exact meaning is:

****kind = 類型／種類****

Therefore:

> ****the kind of opportunity****

= ****「這一類／這種機會」****

The sentence means that you recognized this opportunity as belonging to a particular category:

> difficult and frightening, but important for your growth

So:

> ****the kind of opportunity I could not keep avoiding****

= ****「那種我知道自己不能一直逃避、即使害怕也應該去把握的機會」****

The most important learner contrasts are:

> ****this kind of opportunity****

> = 這類機會

> ****what kind of presentation?****

> = 哪一類簡報？

> ****all kinds of problems****

> = 各種問題

> ****I'm kind of nervous****

> = 我有點緊張

> ****she is kind****

> = 她很善良／體貼

> ****it was kind of her to help****

> = 她願意幫忙很體貼

> ****one of a kind****

> = 獨一無二

> ****kindness****

> = 善意／體貼

So ****kind**** is a beautifully clean polysemy item because the same spelling can mean either:

****kind = type/category****

or:

****kind = caring/considerate****

and in your original passage, it is definitely the ****type/category**** meaning.